12-24 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Dream at Night?

① Almost every person on Earth, including you, has spent **about six years of life dreaming** by the time she reaches 70. That is a surprising number: **six whole years of watching small silent films inside your own head**, most of which you will forget the moment your eyes open. Dreaming is so common, so quiet, and so personal that people rarely ask the simple question: **why does the brain do this every single night?** Scientists have been asking this question for more than 120 years, and while they still do not have one perfect answer, they now understand much more than they did when your grandparents were children. This short article will gently explain, in simple words, **four of the most trusted ideas** today.

② To begin, we must know that **dreaming does not happen all night**. A normal young person's sleep has about **four or five cycles** of roughly 90 minutes each. In each cycle, the brain passes through several quieter stages first, and then enters a special stage called **REM sleep** — REM stands for "Rapid Eye Movement", because during this stage your closed eyes move quickly from side to side, as if watching something. **Almost all long, vivid, story-like dreams happen during REM sleep.** A teenager gets about **100 to 120 minutes of REM sleep per night** — that is why one night usually gives two or three rememberable dreams.

③ **Idea One — "Memory sorting."** The most widely supported idea today is that dreaming helps the brain **sort out the things that happened in the day**. During the day, the brain takes in thousands of small pieces of information: the taste of lunch, a maths formula, a kind word, a sad song, a new classmate's name, a forgotten umbrella. At night, during REM sleep, the brain seems to **open many small drawers** and decide which memories go deep into long-term storage, which memories should be connected to other memories, and which small details can be quietly thrown away. This is why students who sleep well before a big test often remember more — not less — the next morning. Some scientists even say "**sleep is the second half of learning**"; the first half is study, and the second half is dreaming it into the brain.

④ **Idea Two — "Emotion washing."** A second trusted idea is that dreams help the brain **work through strong feelings** — fear, sadness, anger, worry, embarrassment. During REM sleep, a small brain area called the **amygdala** (the "feelings room") is very active, but the **stress chemicals** in the body are at their lowest level of the whole day. This unusual combination gives the brain a rare chance to **revisit a difficult feeling in a calm setting**, a bit like re-watching a scary film in bright daylight. Many people find that after

a night's sleep, a quarrel with a friend feels smaller. That is not imagination — part of that gentler feeling is built, quietly, during dreams.

⑤ **Idea Three — "Problem-solving in disguise."** A third idea is that dreams help the brain **try unusual answers to real problems**. Because the "logic part" of the brain is quieter in REM sleep, the "imagination part" can **freely connect ideas that would normally never meet**. A student might dream that a maths problem is a door, a friend's face is a key, and the key opens the door. The dream sounds silly in the morning — but the brain has, in fact, **practised flexible thinking**. This is why scientists, writers, and even chemists through history have reported that **new ideas sometimes arrive during or just after a dream**.

⑥ **Idea Four — "Brain maintenance."** A fourth simpler idea is that dreaming is a side effect of **the brain's night-time cleaning work**. During sleep, tiny channels between brain cells **open wider** and allow waste products — built up during a busy day — to be gently washed away by a fluid called CSF (**cerebrospinal fluid**). Dreams may be the small stories the brain tells itself while this quiet cleaning happens in the background — a bit like humming while cleaning your room.

⑦ Do all dreams mean something deep? **Most do not.** A random dream about flying to school in a blue shoe probably means only that your brain is sorting, washing, practising, or cleaning — not predicting the future. But dreams are **never a waste of time**. They are the brain's quiet way of **tidying the day, gentling strong feelings, trying new ideas, and cleaning itself** — all at the same time. So tonight, when you turn off your small lamp and close your eyes, remember: the most useful six years of your life may happen with your eyes shut.

注释： REM sleep 快速眼动睡眠；amygdala 杏仁核；cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) 脑脊液；cycle 周期；vivid 清晰的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What two basic facts about dreaming does the article explain at the beginning and in paragraph ②?

A. By the time a person reaches 70, she has spent about six whole years of life dreaming — watching small silent films inside her own head, most of which she forgets the moment her eyes open; dreaming is so common, quiet, and personal that people rarely ask why the brain does this every single night; scientists have been asking this question for more than 120 years and, although they have no single perfect answer, they now understand much more than they did when our grandparents were children; a normal young person's sleep has about four or five roughly 90-minute cycles and in each cycle the brain first passes through quieter stages before entering REM ("Rapid Eye Movement") sleep, during which the closed eyes move quickly side to side as if watching something, and almost all long vivid story-like dreams happen in REM, with a teenager

getting about 100 to 120 minutes of REM sleep per night, which is why one night usually gives two or three rememberable dreams.
B. People dream only three nights a year and only during deep sleep, not REM sleep.
C. Dreaming happens only when a person is awake with her eyes open.
D. Every dream lasts one entire night from bedtime to morning.

2. According to paragraph ③, what is Idea One and how does it connect to learning?

A. Dreaming is the brain using extra energy to make noise.
B. Idea One says dreaming helps the brain sort out the day: during the day the brain takes in thousands of small pieces — a lunch taste, a maths formula, a kind word, a sad song, a new classmate's name, a forgotten umbrella — and at night in REM sleep it opens many small drawers and decides which memories go deep into long-term storage, which memories should connect to other memories, and which small details can quietly be thrown away, which is why students who sleep well before a big test often remember more — not less — the next morning, so that some scientists even say sleep is the second half of learning with study being the first half and dreaming pressing it into the brain as the second half.
C. Dreaming teaches the brain new foreign languages overnight without any effort.
D. Dreaming erases every memory, so students should avoid sleeping before a test.

3. According to paragraph ④, how do dreams help with strong feelings?

A. Dreams make strong feelings stronger by adding more fear to them every night.
B. Dreams have no effect on human feelings and are purely meaningless.
C. Idea Two says dreams help the brain work through strong feelings — fear, sadness, anger, worry, embarrassment: during REM sleep the "feelings room" called the amygdala is very active, but the stress chemicals in the body are at their lowest level of the whole day, and this unusual combination gives the brain a rare chance to revisit a difficult feeling in a calm setting — a bit like re-watching a scary film in bright daylight — which is why after a night's sleep, a quarrel with a friend often feels smaller, and part of that gentler feeling is quietly built during dreams.
D. Dreams help only adults, never middle school students.

4. What does Idea Three explain about problem-solving during dreams?

A. Idea Three says dreams help the brain try unusual answers to real problems: because the "logic part" of the brain is quieter in REM sleep, the "imagination part" can freely connect ideas that would never normally meet — a student may dream that a maths problem is a door, a friend's face is a key, and the key opens the door, which sounds silly in the morning but is in fact the brain practising flexible thinking, and that is why scientists, writers, and even chemists through history have reported that new ideas sometimes arrive during or just after a dream.
B. Dreams solve problems only by giving the sleeper a clear list of answers in plain writing.

C. Dreams block creativity and make people less flexible in their thinking.
D. Only professional scientists, never students, benefit from Idea Three.

5. What is the main message of the last paragraph?

A. Every dream has a deep hidden meaning and predicts the future.
B. Dreams are always a waste of time for the brain and should be avoided.
C. Most dreams do not mean anything deep — a random dream about flying to school in a blue shoe probably means only that the brain is sorting, washing, practising, or cleaning, not predicting the future — yet dreams are never a waste of time, because they are the brain's quiet way of tidying the day, gentling strong feelings, trying new ideas, and cleaning itself all at the same time; so, when a person turns off her small lamp and closes her eyes tonight, the most useful six years of life may happen with her eyes shut.
D. The only job of sleep is to make the body tired the next day.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 + 第②段
【解析】"一生 6 年梦 / 科学问 120 年 / 4–5 周期 / REM / 少年 100–120 分钟"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段
【解析】"白天千信息 / 夜开抽屉分存 / 睡=学习的下半场"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段
【解析】"情绪洗濯 / 杏仁核活 / 压力化学最低 / 争吵变小"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段
【解析】"逻辑脑安静 / 想象自由连接 / 门钥匙 / 科学家新念头"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦段
【解析】"多数无深意 / 但非浪费 / 四种作用同时进行 / 6 年合眼最有用"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。